

ORDINANCES AND REGULATIONS

Ph.D. Programme



Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune

2020

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ORDINANCES & REGULATIONS FOR THE DEGREE OF DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY

PREAMBLE

Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune (IIIT Pune) offers postgraduate programmes leading to the award of Ph.D. degree through its Department. The award of Ph.D. degree is in recognition of high academic achievements, independent research and application of knowledge to the solution of technical and scientific problems in Computer Science and Engineering (CSE); Electronics and Communication Engineering (ECE); Humanities and Social Sciences (HSS); and Mathematics.

The academic programme leading to the Ph.D. degree is broad – based and involves a minimum course credit requirement and a research thesis. The institute also encourages interdisciplinary areas through a system of Co-supervision and provides excellent opportunities for such programs. The institute undertakes sponsored research and development projects from industrial and other organizations in the public as well as private sector.

The degree of Doctor of Philosophy shall be abbreviated as ‘Ph.D.’. The degree of Doctor of Philosophy is granted for research work in areas recognized by the academic Department of the institute subject to the conditions and regulations contained hereinafter.

The research work shall be an original work characterized either by the discovery of facts, or by a fresh approach towards the interpretation and application of facts, or development of equipment making a distinct advancement in instrument technology. It shall evince the candidate’s capacity for critical examination and sound judgment and shall represent original contribution to the existing knowledge.

The degree of Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) of the Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune shall be conferred on a candidate who fulfils all the requirements specified in these Ordinances and Regulations.

ORDINANCES FOR THE DEGREE OF DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY

O1. DEFINITIONS

- (i) **“Applicant”** shall mean an individual who applies for admission to the Ph.D. programme of the Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune (IIIT Pune) on a prescribed Application Form.
- (ii) **“Candidate”** shall mean a person registered for the Ph.D. Degree and who has successfully completed the course requirement, the comprehensive examination and has submitted an approved research plan as per R.7 of the Regulations.
- (iii) **“Co-supervisor”** shall mean an additional supervisor approved by the Director on the recommendation of Dean to help in the accomplishment of the research work of the student/candidate, as per R.5 of the Regulations.
- (iv) **“Course Advisor”** shall mean a faculty member nominated by the Dean to chalk-out the programme of study of a student registered for the Ph.D. and to advise him/her on the courses to be taken by him/her. If a supervisor (s) has already been appointed, he/she shall be the Courses Advisor for that student.
- (v) **“Course work”** shall mean courses of study prescribed in the Department through the course Advisor to be undertaken by a student registered for the Ph.D. Degree.
- (vi) **“Dean”** shall mean the Dean, Research of the Institute.
- (vii) **“Degree”** shall mean the Degree of Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) of the Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune.
- (viii) **“DRC”** shall mean Research Committee of the Department, which shall consist of faculty members of the Department.
- (ix) **“Full-time Research Student/Candidate”** shall mean a person registered for the Ph.D. Degree devoting full time for completing the degree requirements.
- (x) **“Institute Research Student/Candidate”** shall mean a person registered for the Institute Ph.D. Degree.
- (xi) **“Minimum Registration Period”** shall mean the minimum period for which a candidate must be registered, including the time spent as student before becoming a candidate, prior to submission of the thesis.

- (xii) **“ODC”** shall mean Oral Defense Committee.
- (xiii) **“Part time Research Student/Candidate”** a person who is registered for the Ph.D. degree and will devote part of his/her time towards this pursuit.
- (xiv) **“Registration Period”** shall mean the length of time span commencing with the date of initial registration at the institute.
- (xv) **“SRC”** shall mean Student Research Committee.
- (xvi) **“Sponsored Research Student/ Candidate”** shall mean a research student/candidate except that he/she receives complete financial support from the sponsoring organization/his (her) employer.
- (xvii) **“Student”** shall mean a person registered for the Ph.D. degree prior to becoming a candidate.
- (xviii) **“Supervisor”** shall mean a member of the academic staff of the Institute approved by DRC to supervise the research/ academic work of the student/candidate.

O2. The minimum entry qualification for admission to the Ph.D. programme shall be:

Computer Science and Engineering: B. Tech. / B.E. in CSE/ IT or relevant area/ MCA (with valid GATE score) with a CGPA of at least 6.5 on a scale of 10 (or equivalent) or 65 %. OR M. Tech. /M.E. in CSE/ IT or relevant area with a CGPA of at least 6 on a scale of 10 (or equivalent) or 60 %.

Electronics & Communication Engineering: B. Tech./ B.E. (with valid GATE score) in ECE/ EE or relevant area with a CGPA of at least 6.5 on a scale of 10 (or equivalent) or 60 %. OR M. Tech. / M.E. in ECE/ EE or relevant area with a CGPA of at least 6 on a scale of 10 (or equivalent) or 60 %.

Humanities, Social Sciences & Management: M.A. English/ M.Phil. in English Literature, Linguistics and allied areas of Social Sciences/ MBA with a CGPA of at least 6.5 on a scale of 10 (or equivalent) or 60 %.

Applied Mathematics & Data Science: A master's degree in the Mathematics/Statistics OR bachelors in engineering OR Mathematics (4-year Programme) with a minimum of 55 percent marks/ CPI of 5.5/10.

* A 5% or 0.5 GPA on a scale of 10 relaxation shall be given to SC/ST/PwD applicants as per Govt. of India norms.

O3. A candidate registered for the Ph.D. programme shall be required to satisfy a minimum Registration period requirement, as laid down in the Regulations (R.5).

O4. A student/candidate shall be required to earn prescribed minimum credits through courses and carry out his/her research work at the Institute, under the guidance of approved supervisor(s).

O5. A candidate will be required to complete all the requirements for the award of the degree within a period specified in the regulations.

O6. The date of initial registration shall normally be the date on which the student formally registers for the first time in the beginning of a Semester for the Ph.D. programme, which shall also be the date of his/her joining the programme for all the intents and purposes.

O7. For a student to become a candidate for the degree, he/she shall have to satisfy the requirements as laid down in the Regulations and be accepted by the SRC.

O8. If a student/candidate withdraws from Ph.D. programme or his/her registration is terminated, his/her student/candidate status ceases. If such a candidate is re-admitted, he/she may be given weightage of the credits acquired during the previous registration on the recommendation of DRC except in the case of termination on disciplinary grounds.

O9. The award of the Ph.D. Degree to an eligible candidate shall be made in accordance with the Regulations of the Institute.

REGULATIONS FOR THE DEGREE OF DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY

The following Regulations shall apply to all categories of students/candidates pursuing courses of study and research leading to the Ph.D. degree:

R.1 CLASSIFICATIONS

Students enrolled to the Ph.D. program shall be categorized under any one of the following categories which will be decided and recommended by SRC/DRC.

Type 1 (Candidates with Institute Fellowship):

Candidates under this category shall fulfil the minimum eligibility criteria given in **O2**. Scholarship should be provided to the full-time Ph.D. students admitted under this category. These students are required to assist 8 (eight) hours of work per week assigned by the institute.

Type 2 (Candidates with external Fellowship):

Addition to the minimum entry qualifications, applicants who have qualified UGC/CSIR NET-JRF exam or have obtained INSPIRE PhD fellowship, will be admitted based on their performance in the entrance test and subsequent interview. The institute does not provide any assistantship or fellowship to such a student, however, they receive their fellowship from their supporting organizations (UGC/ CSIR/ DRDO/ AICTE)/ Industry/ Academic Institute etc. Candidates who are working on various Projects undertaken by the institute can also be admitted to Ph.D. programme.

Type 3 (Candidates from Industry, Govt./Private Research Labs, Educational Institutes):

Additionally, the candidates should also fulfil any one of the following criteria:

- a) M.E./M.Tech in CSE, ECE or allied areas with minimum 1 year of documented working experience. The experience gained after graduation can be considered in this regard.
- b) B.E./ B. Tech. in CSE, ECE or allied areas, or MCA /M.Sc. in Mathematics or Statistics/ M.A. English/ M.Phil. in English Literature, Linguistics and allied areas of Social Sciences with minimum 3 years of documented working experience. A valid GATE score is not mandatory for such candidates.

Type 4 (Self-financed):

Candidates under this category are those who support themselves in their personal capacity. These candidates shall fulfil the minimum eligibility criteria given in **O2**.

R.2 RESERVATION/ RELAXATION

1. Reservation / Relaxation for SC / ST / PH and OBC shall be as per the norms of the Ministry of Human Resource Development (MHRD).

2. The SC/ST/ PH applicants may be allowed 5% relaxation in marks or 0.5 relaxation in GPA. Physically handicapped applicants will not be allowed any other relaxation beyond this limit even if they belong to SC/ST category, etc.

R.3 SELECTION PROCEDURE

The Institute may set the short listing criteria, if considered necessary, higher than the minimum eligibility defined above, and will conduct test/ interview for admission to Ph.D. Programme with the approval from Director.

R.4 REGISTRATION

1. Every student/candidate will be required to register every semester till the submission of the thesis. The registration shall be subject to the completion of specified number of credits / courses and/or satisfactory progress in his/her research work as recommended by the SRC.
2. Candidates having qualifying degree as M.Tech shall complete coursework of at least 12 credits. Candidates having qualifying degree as B.Tech shall complete coursework of at least 15 credits.
3. Online courses from SWAYAM, NPTEL and Coursera can also be considered for awarding credits equivalent to a subject credit, provided that the consent of registration is given by the Supervisor/SRC and recommended by the Dean. The evaluation shall be carried out at the Institute level.
4. All the PhD entrants, irrespective of discipline, shall take at least one credit-based course in teaching/education/pedagogy related to their chosen PhD subject. The course shall be registered during the commencement of the course work. One/ two certified courses from the online platforms mentioned in **R.4.3** can also be considered for registration at the discretion of director.
5. The candidates of all categories shall normally submit their thesis within a period of five (5) years from the date of their initial registration for the Ph.D. programme but not within three (3) years from date of initial registration. However, as a special case, this limit may be extended to a maximum of seven (7) years on the recommendation by SRC and approval by Director, after which the registration shall stand cancelled automatically.

R.5 THESIS SUPERVISOR(s)

1. Every admitted student shall be assigned a Research Supervisor(s) by the recommendation of Dean as per preference of the student, subject to the approval of Director. For this purpose, the process will be completed during first year of the student's joining.
2. On the recommendations of the SRC and Dean, Director, may appoint more than one supervisor(s) not exceeding a total of two to supervise the student/candidate. These may be from inside or outside the Institute/ Research Organization/ Industry. Appointment of any other supervisor(s) would not be made normally after the lapse of eighteen (18) calendar months from the date of initial registration of the student/candidate. However, if appointed, he/she will be designated as co-supervisor. In special circumstances, Director may allot a research supervisor with consultation of SRC/DRC.

3. Number of Scholars Under a Faculty:

The maximum of scholars supervised by a faculty member at any time shall not be more than Eight (8) singly or Ten (10) jointly or a combination of both, the aggregate not exceeding eight as given below:

Assistant Professor: 4

Associate Professor: 6

Professor: 8

Joint supervision of a Ph.D. scholar will be treated as 0.5 per faculty member.

4. Appointment of Supervisors for Ph.D. students:

A faculty member appointed as a Ph.D. supervisor from Institute is normally expected to be available to a research student/candidate in the Institute till the thesis is submitted. However, under unavoidable circumstances, such as: long leave of more than twelve (12) months; resignation; retirement; or death; a supervisor may not be available to the student/scholar. In such special cases, appointment of supervisor(s) will be regulated and recommended by SRC.

R.6 COURSE CREDIT/ CGPA REQUIREMENTS

1. Each student will be required to take some courses as described in R.4 of the Ordinance. Students earn credits for a course only if he/she obtains a minimum of 'C' Grade in each course and minimum CGPA requirements as 7.0 for successfully completing the course work.
2. SRC may recommend additional course(s) as Audit course(s), if required, in a particular case. Student earns credit for Audit course (s) if he/she obtains a minimum of Pass Grade for successfully completing the course.
3. The pre-Ph.D. courses including Audit courses are to be completed successfully in three/four semesters (counted from the date of registration).
4. The courses offered for the Ph.D. programs may be Lecture courses, Laboratory courses, Design courses, Mini Projects and Seminars. Each seminar shall carry two credits and shall be treated as a course for the purpose of registration and evaluation. A student shall not take more than one seminar during the coursework.

R.7 COMPREHENSIVE EXAMINATION

1. Soon after successfully completing the pre-Ph.D. course requirements (coursework), each student will be required to take a comprehensive examination and qualify it. It will test students' comprehension of his/her broad field of research and his/her academic preparation and potential to carry out the proposed research plan. Comprehensive examination within the stipulated time frame of Eighteen to Twenty-four (18-24) months, shall invariably be conducted by the concerned Department. The comprehensive examination should be a combination of written and oral examination and should be separately conducted before the evaluation of the research proposal. The examination will be conducted by a committee called Student's Research Committee (SRC), which will be constituted as follows:
 - a. Chairman, DRC or his/her nominee: Chairman
 - b. One expert in the field from the Department.
 - c. One expert, preferably in the concerned area, from outside the Department/ Institute to which the students belongs.
 - d. Supervisor(s):Member Experts at (b) and (c) above will be recommended by the Dean and will be approved by the Director.

2. The Student's Research Committee (SRC) on the basis of the performance of the student in the examination will make one of the following recommendations:
 - a. (i) Passed
 - (ii) To re-appear in the examination after the defined period of the time specified by the SRC and after taking additional courses, if any.
 - (iii) Failed.
- b. Research plan
 - (i) Approved
 - (ii) Not approved
3. A student will be provided the maximum of two attempts to pass the comprehensive examination.

R.8 ELIGIBILITY FOR THE CANDIDACY FOR THE DEGREE

1. The student shall make a request for the candidacy for the Ph.D. degree through SRC, after having passed the comprehensive examination. He/she shall be evaluated for candidacy for Ph.D. degree program.
2. A student shall be formally registered as a candidate for the Ph. D. degree after he/she complied with the following:
 - a. has completed his/her course work;
 - b. has passed the comprehensive examination; and
 - c. has submitted a research plan duly recommended and approved by SRC.

R.9 PERFORMANCE MONITORING

1. The academic/research progress of each student/candidate will be monitored by DRC. For this purpose, each candidate will be asked to submit a progress report at the end of each semester to Chairman-DRC through supervisor(s).
2. The Chairman-DRC in the Department will be coordinating collection of progress report written and signed by the student/candidate and forwarded by the supervisor(s) every semester.
3. The Supervisor(s) and SRC will evaluate the progress report of the student.
4. 'S' grade is to be awarded during that semester if the progress is 'Satisfactory'.

5. If the progress is 'Unsatisfactory', 'U' grade is to be awarded and appropriate action taken. For the first appearance of 'U' grade, a warning would be issued to the candidate.
6. If there are two consecutive 'U's, the registration in Ph.D. Programme will stand terminated.
7. Submission of progress report should continue till the submission of thesis.
8. The terms of research will be as follows:
1st Term: July to December;
2nd Term: January to June
9. The academic calendar will include the following dates for the submission of the progress report.

R.10 SEMINAR AND SYNOPSIS

1. Seminar

- a) SRC shall assess work through the pre-synopsis seminar. The student can submit the synopsis only if the SRC and external subject expert are satisfied about the quality of the work for submission as a Ph.D. thesis.
- b) The research work shall be supported with a substantial work with preferably two (2) accepted/ published papers in a refereed journal (non-paid SCI/ Scopus).
- c) Details of the pre-synopsis seminar shall be adequately notified so as to enable interested staff members and students to attend it.

2. Synopsis

- a) The synopsis should be submitted normally within two (2) months after the presentation of pre-synopsis seminar. In case the synopsis is not submitted in the specified period, the student may be asked to present another pre-synopsis seminar.
- b) On completion of the research work the candidate shall submit to SRC through supervisor(s), Five (5) copies of the synopsis. The SRC will forward the synopsis with its recommendations to the Dean for approval by the Director.
- c) The candidate shall be required to submit fresh synopsis if he/she fails to submit his/her thesis within Six (6) months of submission of earlier synopsis.

However, in case a candidate fails to submit his/her thesis within the stipulated time and has suitable justification for the same, the Director, may on recommendations made by the SRC

and Dean, and on individual merits of each case grant him extension in time by not more than two months, i.e. the candidate may be allowed to submit his/her thesis within a period normally not exceeding eight (8) months from the date of submission of synopsis.

R.11 BOARD OF EXAMINERS

A panel of at least ten (10) experts in the area of the Ph.D. thesis would be suggested by Supervisor(s) and recommended by the SRC while forwarding the Title and Synopsis of the thesis. The panel so recommended would include at least 40% of the examiners from outside India. At least three examiner's from the panel of Indian and at least two from the panel of foreign examiner's will be approved by the Director in the order of preference.

On receipt of the Title and Synopsis of the thesis and panel of examiners recommended by SRC, the Dean will forward the recommended board of examiners by SRC for each candidate to the Director for approval. The board will consist of internal examiner(s), normally the supervisor(s), and at least two external examiners: at least one from within India and at least one from abroad, who shall be expert in the subject of the thesis. These external examiners shall be chosen normally from panel of examiners recommended by the SRC as aforesaid. A person working in the same Laboratory/ Institution(s) where research candidate is employed cannot, however, be appointed as External Examiner for evaluating the thesis of that Research Candidate. Further no person can be appointed as external examiner from Laboratory/ Institution to which the Co-Supervisor(s) of the Research Candidate belongs.

R.12 THESIS SUBMISSION

The thesis should bear the evidence of the candidate's capacity for analysis and judgment as well as his/her ability to carry out independent investigation, design or development. No part of the thesis or supplementary published work shall have been submitted for the award of any other degree or diploma.

1. The thesis shall be written in English in the specific format and shall contain critical account of the candidate's research. It should be characterized by discovery of facts or fresh approach towards interpretation of facts and theories or significant contribution to knowledge or development or a combination of these. It should bear evidence of the candidate's capacity for analysis and judgment as well as his/her ability to carry out independent investigation, design or development.

2. A candidate may submit his/her thesis within the time period as stipulated in **R.4.4**; provided that he/she has become a candidate for the award of Ph.D. degree as provided in **R.7.2**; and he/she has submitted the Title and Synopsis of the thesis at least two (2) month prior to the submission of the thesis.
3. The candidate for the degree shall submit three copies of thesis with a soft cover. In case of co-supervision four copies of thesis shall be submitted by the candidate.

R.13 THESIS EVALUATION

1. Each examiner will be requested to submit to the Dean a detailed assessment report and his/her recommendations on the prescribed Proforma with in twelve weeks of the date of receiving the thesis.
2. In the event of the report not being received from an examiner with in a period of three months, a reminder shall be sent to the examiner to submit the report within two weeks. If the report is not received after the stipulated time, then the Dean may appoint from the panel of examiner's already approved by the Director in order of preference, another examiner in his/her place for evaluating the thesis with due approval from the Director.
3. (a) Examiners will examine the thesis individually with a view to judge that the thesis is a piece of research work characterized by;
 - (i) The discovery of facts, or
 - (ii) A fresh approach towards interpretation and application of facts or theories, or
 - (iii) A distinct advancement in theoretical or experimental research.
- (b) The examiner will be required to give his/her opinion about candidate's capacity for critical examination and sound judgment. The internal examiners shall be submitting one report. Examiners will submit the reports on prescribed form clearly stating that;
 - (i) The thesis is recommended for the award of Ph.D., or
 - (ii) The thesis is recommended for the award of Ph.D. Degree subject to the candidate giving satisfactory answers to queries specifically mentioned in the report at the time of viva-voce examination, or
 - (iii) The candidate will be allowed to resubmit the thesis in the revised form, or
 - (iv) The thesis is rejected.

- (c) (i) If all the three examiners recommend acceptance of the thesis, their recommendations shall be accepted.
- (ii) If two of the three examiners recommend rejection, their decision would be accepted. The candidate may, however, be allowed to resubmit the thesis normally after one year. Normal process will be followed for the evaluation of the thesis.
- (iii) If one of the examiners recommends rejection, the candidate's replies to the comments made by the examiners shall be sent to the examiners and his/her clear verdict sought. The examiner may then recommend acceptance, rejection or revision. In case the thesis is accepted, sub-clause (i) above will be applicable. In case of recommendation for revision, sub-clause (iv) will apply. However, if the examiner still recommends rejection, a fourth examiner would be appointed from the panel and approved by the Director. In such cases sub-clause (v) will apply.
- (iv) In case one examiner recommends revision of the thesis, the thesis would be revised normally within one year, if the candidate so desires. The revised version of the thesis would be sent to all the examiners for their recommendations. If the candidate does not agree for revision he/she may ask for appointment of the fourth examiner under sub-clause (v) below:
- (v) The new examiner if appointed, shall be Indian or Foreign depending on whether the thesis was rejected by an Indian or a foreign examiner in the first instance. The reports of all examiners will be sent to him/her without revealing the identity of the examiner, along with the response of the candidate, if any, to these. The thesis shall be deemed to be acceptable if three out of four examiners recommend acceptance. If the fourth examiner recommends revision, the thesis would be suitably revised and resubmitted normally after three (3) months and sent for examination to all the examiners except to the one in whose place the fourth examiner was appointed. In case the fourth examiner recommends rejection or his/her recommendations for revision is not accepted by the candidate, the thesis would be rejected.
- (vi) If two of three examiners recommend revision of the thesis the candidate may revise the thesis accordingly and resubmit it normally within a period of one year for the evaluation by the same set of examiners.

- (vii) The correspondence regarding (c), (d) and (e) above will be done by the Dean.
- (viii) If one examiner recommends rejection and other examiner recommends revision of the thesis, the candidates may revise the thesis and resubmit it normally within a period of one year, for evaluation by the same set of examiners.
- (d) Any doubt arising out of following the procedure laid down in **R.13.3(c)** above shall be referred to the Director for a decision.
- (e) In case of ambiguous recommendations by the examiner, Dean will approach the examiner for a clear recommendation. In case clear recommendation is not forthcoming, the matter may be referred to the Director for his/her decision.

R.14 RE-SUBMISSION

1. In case of resubmission of thesis, the student will have to submit the semester fees till he/she re-submits the thesis.
2. The revised thesis may be submitted after one year and normally within two years from the date of such intimation.
3. No candidate shall be allowed to resubmit the same thesis more than once.

R.15 VIVA-VOCE EXAMINATION

1. If the thesis is recommended for the award of degree, the candidate shall be required to defend his/her work/thesis orally (viva-voce examination) before a duly constituted committee hereinafter referred to as the Oral Defense Committee (ODC).
2. The ODC shall consist Supervisor(s) (internal examiners), and at least one Indian external examiner, and SRC. The internal examiner shall arrange the viva-voce examination of candidate.
3. a) In case of non availability of the Indian External Examiner in conducting the viva-voce examination, the Director may appoint another examiner to conduct the via-voce examination from the existing panel. If need be, the SRC may suggest a fresh panel of examiners.
b)The viva-voce examiners shall be provided with the comments made by the examiners before the viva-voce examination.
c) If there is a difference of opinion among the viva-voce examiners, the recommendations of the viva-voce Board will be put up to the Director for a

decision who may either direct that a fresh viva be held or recommend acceptance or otherwise to the Senate.

- d) Internal Examiner(s) shall arrange for the viva-voce examination of the candidate as early as possible and normally within two months from the date of communication to the Internal Examiner for holding the viva-voce examination.
- e) In case of the inability of the internal examiner(s) to have the viva-voce examination conducted due to any reason whatsoever, the Director may appoint another Internal Examiner(s) from amongst faculty from DRC concerned who belongs to the particular field in consultation with Dean concerned to conduct the viva-voce examination. In such cases also, the Ph.D. work will be deemed to have been carried out under the guidance of the supervisor(s) only.
- f) Any other matter not explicitly provided herein or of an exceptional nature may be referred to the Director for his/her decision.

R.16 AWARD OF Ph.D. DEGREE

1. On the completion of all stages of the examination, the Oral Defense Committee shall recommend to the Dean, one of the following courses of action:
 - a) That the degree be awarded;
 - b) That the candidate be re-examined at a later specified time in a specified manner;
 - c) That the degree shall not be awarded. The thesis will be rejected on the conclusion that the thesis is not genuinely the work of candidate.

In case of (a) and (b), the Oral Defense Committee shall also provide to the candidate a list of all corrections and modifications in the thesis evaluation. The second viva-voce examination may be held normally after a period of three (3) months.

2. The degree shall be awarded by the Senate, provided that:
 - a) The Oral Defense Committee so recommends;
 - b) The candidate produces a 'No dues Certificate' in prescribed form.
 - c) The candidate has submitted three hard cover copies of the thesis; one for the Central Library, one to the examination cell and one to the Supervisor. The thesis should incorporate all necessary corrections / modifications.

R.17 WITHDRAWAL FROM SEMESTER/ COURSES

1. A student/candidate may be permitted to withdraw upon the approval of Director from all the courses registered by him or the entire semester, on medical grounds supported by a medical certificate issued by a registered Medical Practitioner at government hospital where the student/ candidate has valid reasons for his/her absence from the institute.
2. Under no circumstances will a request for withdrawal be entertained after the major tests have begun. Student/Candidate should present the medical certificate in support of his/her absence on health reasons within two days of his/her rejoining the institute, if not produced already. Withdrawal will not be granted retrospectively.
3. The period of authorized absence in the semester should not be less than eight weeks of contact period for Semester withdrawal to be granted. Regularity in attending the classes and satisfactory performance in the mid-term examinations, if any, held prior to the date of application for withdrawal are the factors which would be taken into account while recommending/granting withdrawal.
4. Any semester withdrawal will count towards the maximum limit of seven years as stipulated above.

R.18 CANCELLATION OF REGISTRATION

Registration of a student/candidate shall be cancelled in any one of the following eventualities, after due approval of Director.

1. If he/she resigns from the Ph.D. Programme and the resignation is duly recommended by the Supervisor.
2. If he/she fails to renew his/her registration in any semester subject to the provision contained in these Ordinances & Regulations.
3. If his/her academic progress is found unsatisfactory as described in **R.9.6**.
4. If all the prescribed Pre-Ph.D. Courses are not successfully completed within the stipulated time frame.
5. If he/she does not clear the comprehensive examination as stipulated.
6. If he/she is found involved in an act of misconduct and/or indiscipline and termination has been recommended by a competent authority.

R.19 SUPERVISION OF Ph.D. STUDENTS OF OTHER INSTITUTES/ UNIVERSITIES

An IIIT Pune faculty may supervise & guide Ph.D. students of other institutes/universities subject to the following conditions:

1. The host Institute/University is recognized by MHRD/UGC/AICTE.
2. The total number of such externally enrolled Ph.D. students under any faculty of IIIT Pune, should not be more than two (2) at any point of time. This number is to be included in the maximum number of Ph.D. students that a faculty of IIIT Pune may supervise as per **R.5.3**.
3. Due to extension of this facility to the host institute, the work of the IIIT Pune should not suffer.
4. If the concerned faculty of IIIT Pune, as co-supervisor is required to visit the Institute/Outside, he/she shall seek specific approval for the visit on Casual Leave/leave as due, by the competent authority and shall not be on duty for the visit. Further, all expenses, facilities etc. in this regard shall be borne by the host Institution.
5. If the external candidate wishes to avail the facilities at IIIT Pune, he/she shall register as a student for a period not exceeding six months as per rules and regulations.

The host Institute/University as per regulations appoints a foreigner as one of the examiners for Ph.D. thesis or else it is recognized by IIIT Pune, for this purpose. Wherever, the foreign examiner is not appointed, the Director is authorized to take such a decision.

R.20 GENERAL

1. Notwithstanding anything contained in these Ordinances & Regulations, all categories of the students/candidates shall be governed by the rules and procedures framed by the Senate in this behalf, and in force from time to time.
2. **Unfair means and Plagiarism:**
 - a. In cases a student is found adopting or suspected of adopting unfair means before, during and after the examination or lifting of some other's works(s) and inserting it in his/her project, seminar and dissertation etc. without proper acknowledge, credit and reference or plagiarizing the dissertation/project report etc. such penal action shall be

taken by the Institute as may be necessary to uphold the sanctity and integrity of the examination system and the creditability of the Institute. A review committee constituted at institute level will carefully examine the thesis about its content authenticity.

b. All such cases may be taken suo-moto cognizance of by the Institute. Such cases may also be reported by examiners/invigilators to Dean for consideration. After giving an opportunity to the concerned student(s) to explain the conduct/defend the charge, the Director shall take action including imposition of appropriate penalty including award of 'F' Grade in the concerned course(s) on the concerned student(s).

R.21 INTERPRETATION

1. Any doubt or dispute about the interpretation of these Ordinances and Regulations shall be referred to the Chairman, Senate whose decisions shall be final.
2. Eligibility for admission to Ph.D. in different disciplines is summarized in the Ordinances. This may be reviewed from time to time by the Institution and approved by the Senate.
3. Any other matter not covered in the Ordinances & Regulations shall be referred to the Director.

Disclaimer: These Ordinances may be reviewed from time to time.